DHARA PARIKH

Senior Graphic Designer | Brand & Retail Design

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PROFILE

Graphic designer and art director with 15+ years of experience in branding, marketing campaigns, packaging, and digital and print design. Work spans clients in India, Denmark and the USA, with a record of leading creative teams, improving design workflows and delivering consistent visual identities. Portfolio includes retail installations, editorial typography and brand communications.

CORE SKILLS

Brand Identity | Retail Branding | Marketing Collateral | Product Packaging | Typography & Layout | Digital Graphics | Illustration | Art Direction | Adobe Creative Suite | Figma

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Freelance UI/Graphic Designer and Brand Consultant

Freelance | California | India, Denmark and USA clients — 08/2008 - Present

- Delivered end-to-end creative solutions spanning brand identity, advertising and promotional assets.
- Developed brand transformations for clients in India, Denmark and the USA, strengthening brand visibility and consistency.
- Designed and launched digital marketing campaigns and product packaging to improve client recognition and customer engagement.
- Built long-term client relationships through on-time project delivery aligned with clients' strategic goals.

Media Head (UX + Graphics)

Exit Design | Bengaluru, India — 08/2014 - 08/2020

- Led a cross-functional design team producing award-winning branding, catalogs and marketing collateral.
- Streamlined creative workflows, reducing design turnaround time by 20% without compromising quality.
- Directed media and UX campaigns that increased customer engagement by 15% across digital platforms.
- Introduced design research frameworks that enhanced user experience and increased adoption of digital interfaces.

Brand Manager - Lead

Spacewood Furnishers Pvt. Ltd. | Mumbai, India — 08/2016 - 07/2020

- Led the company's transition from manufacturing to retail within 20 months, achieving 25% revenue CAGR.
- Increased national brand visibility by 20% through integrated retail branding and market expansion initiatives.
- Conceptualized and launched retail campaigns that increased consumer engagement and sales across key markets.
- Aligned cross-functional teams on retail product launches, supporting faster adoption and sustained profitability.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE, CONTINUED

Art Director

Scion Brand Consultancy | Bengaluru, India 06/2014 - 08/2016

- Directed creative work across digital and print media, maintaining consistent brand expression.
- Developed prototypes, sketches and visual concepts for strategic client pitches that won new business.
- Supervised and mentored junior designers to support creative growth and improve output quality.
- Streamlined creative processes while maintaining design quality.

Senior Graphic Designer

Grandmother India | Mumbai, India 06/2009 - 07/2010

- Created marketing graphics for high-profile campaigns to strengthen client visibility and engagement.
- Presented creative concepts and collaborated with clients to refine layouts, typography and design presentations.
- Produced print-ready promotional materials using Adobe Creative Suite.

DESIGN EDUCATION & MENTORSHIP

Design Educator (Volunteer)

Symbiosis Institute of Planning and Design | India 07/2020 - 07/2022

Designed curriculum and taught design courses, encouraging critical thinking and contemporary creative practices.

SELECTED PORTFOLIO WORK

Asian Paints | ColorNext: Concept, art direction and installation for retail posters, merchandise and stationery.

Good Earth | Brand communications: Website revamp, price tags and event invitations, with concept and art direction.

Everything in Between | Editorial design: Coffee-table book exploring typographic experimentation, illustration and visual storytelling.

EDUCATION

Graduate coursework, MFA program in Graphic Design
Academy of Art University | San Francisco, CA | 06/2008

Bachelor of Architecture (B.Arch)
Visvesvaraya National Institute of Technology | India | 05/2005

RECOGNITION

Promoted to Brand Manager within 12 months for creative leadership and results. Recognized as Employee of the Year for teamwork and performance.